Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-13

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 24:1-31

1 Now these are the divisions of the sons of Aaron. The sons of Aaron were Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

2 And Nadab and Abihu died before their father, and had no children; therefore Eleazar and Ithamar ministered as priests.

3 Then David with Zadok of the sons of Eleazar, and Ahimelech of the sons of Ithamar, divided them according to the schedule of their service.

4 There were more leaders found of the sons of Eleazar than of the sons of Ithamar, and thus they were divided. Among the sons of Eleazar were sixteen heads of their fathers' houses, and eight heads of their fathers' houses among the sons of Ithamar.

5 Thus they were divided by lot, one group as another, for there were officials of the sanctuary and officials of the house of God, from the sons of Eleazar and from the sons of Ithamar.

6 And the scribe, Shemaiah the son of Nethanel, one of the Levites, wrote them down before the king, the leaders, Zadok the priest, Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the priests and Levites, one father's house taken for Eleazar and one for Ithamar.

7 Now the first lot fell to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah,

8 the third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim,

9 the fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to Mijamin,

10 the seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah,

11 the ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah,

12 the eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim,

13 the thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab,

14 the fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer,

15 the seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Happizzez,

16 the nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezekel,

17 the twenty-first to Jachin, the twenty-second to Gamul,

18 the twenty-third to Delaiah, the twenty-fourth to Maaziah.

19 This was the schedule of their service for coming into the house of the Lord according to their ordinance by the hand of Aaron their father, as the Lord God of Israel had commanded him.

20 And the rest of the sons of Levi: of the sons of Amram, Shubael; of the sons of Shubael, Jehdeiah.

21 Concerning Rehabiah, of the sons of Rehabiah, the first was Isshiah.

22 Of the Izharites, Shelomoth; of the sons of Shelomoth, Jahath.

23 Of the sons of Hebron, Jeriah was the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth.

24 Of the sons of Uzziel, Michah; of the sons of Michah, Shamir.

25 The brother of Michah, Isshiah; of the sons of Isshiah, Zechariah.

26 The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi; the son of Jaaziah, Beno.

27 The sons of Merari by Jaaziah were Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri.

28 Of Mahli: Eleazar, who had no sons.

29 Of Kish: the son of Kish, Jerahmeel.

30 Also the sons of Mushi were Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites according to their fathers' houses.

31 These also cast lots just as their brothers the sons of Aaron did, in the presence of King David, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the priests and Levites. The chief fathers did just as their younger brethren.

II. Key Summary

• Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu died before their father and had no children, so Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests; David, together with Zadok and Ahimelech, divided them according to the schedule of their service.

• Eleazar's family had sixteen heads and Ithamar's had eight; all of them were ordered by lot into twenty-four divisions, and the scribe Shemaiah wrote down their names before the king, the leaders, and the priests.

• The rest of the Levites also cast lots before King David just as the sons of Aaron did, and the text notes that "the chief fathers did just as their younger brethren."

III. Passage Analysis

Drawing Lots: No One Could Cry "Unfair"

> "It was made by lot, that the disposal thereof might be of the Lord, and so all quarrels and contentions might be prevented, and no man could be charged with partiality, nor could any say that they had wrong done them." [1]

David was the king and could have simply picked who went first, but he handed the order over to God. That way nobody could complain about favoritism, and nobody had to fight for a better spot.

Older and Younger on the Same Line

> "'The chief fathers did just as their younger brethren' shows that everyone was treated the same when the lots were cast, with no distinction made for seniority, ability, or experience... no one is more important than anyone else, and no one is more qualified than anyone else." [2]

In this draw, being older or coming from a bigger family didn't move you up the line. Getting to serve in God's house wasn't about who had the most seniority or status; it was a chance God gave.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time your class, team, or family used a draw or a rotation to hand out jobs, where

did you end up, and what was your first reaction?

In 1 Chronicles 24, the chief fathers cast lots just as their younger brethren did, so before God no one is more qualified than anyone else, and every place on the schedule is a chance to serve that God Himself hands out.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary (1 Chronicles 24), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_024.cfm

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), 1 Chronicles 24 Gleanings (Comprehensive Interpretation of 1 Chronicles), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT24.htm